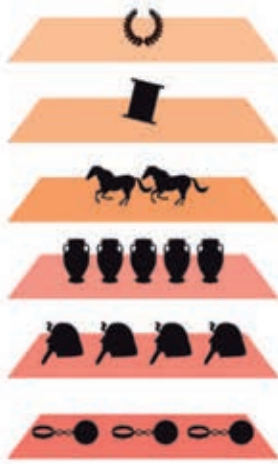


SOCIAL STRUCTURE

The emperor ruled the empire. He held enormous power but depended on the support of rich aristocratic families. Below them were ordinary Roman citizens. However, women and "foreigners" from places the Romans had conquered did not have citizenship and could not vote.



EMPEROR

The emperor (or emperors) was the ultimate authority.

SENATORS

Leading aristocrats served in the Senate.

EQUESTRIANS

Below senators were the less wealthy equestrians.

TRADERS AND WORKERS

Urban workers and merchants had little power.

FOREIGNERS

Outside Italy, most men did not have Roman citizenship.

SLAVES

Slaves had very few legal rights.

DAILY LIFE

The family played a central role in Roman life. Each household was ruled by the eldest adult male. Women carried out domestic chores and performed rituals to household gods.



COLANDER

STONE GRINDER

GLASS BOTTLE

OIL FLASK

RING

ROMAN KINGDOM

750–510 BCE

Romulus kills his twin to become the first king of Rome. Later, the city is ruled by six kings. Under them, the city grows slowly. The last king, Tarquinius Superbus, is overthrown.

ROMAN REPUBLIC

507–27 BCE

Rome's kings are replaced by elected leaders. The republic lasts for nearly five centuries, until civil wars lead to its collapse.

ROMAN EMPIRE

27 BCE–395 CE

The final victor in Rome's civil wars takes power as Emperor Augustus. For the next four centuries Rome is ruled by a succession of emperors.

EASTERN AND WESTERN EMPIRE

395–476 CE

As the Roman Empire faces new threats, a single emperor cannot defend it. The rule is split between two emperors – one based in Rome and the other in Constantinople.

TIMELINE

As their empire grew, the Romans' political system changed to meet the challenge of governing this vast area. They also fought many wars.

753 BCE

According to legend, the city of Rome is founded by Romulus and Remus, the twin sons of Mars, the god of war.



Statue of Romulus and Remus

509 BCE

Roman Republic is established after the overthrow of King Tarquinius.

261–241 BCE

Rome wins the first Punic War against the North African city of Carthage.



Soldiers in Carthage look at boats burning in distance

218–201 BCE

Carthaginian general Hannibal almost conquers Italy, but is defeated in the Second Punic War.



Head of Hannibal on a coin

44 BCE

Julius Caesar, Roman general and dictator, is assassinated after his victory in the civil war against his rival Pompey.

27 BCE

Julius Caesar's adopted son Octavian defeats his last rivals in a new civil war. He becomes the first Roman emperor and takes the name Augustus.



Bust of Julius Caesar

80 BCE

One of the great examples of Roman engineering, the Colosseum is finished.

The largest amphitheatre in the empire, it seats 50,000 spectators.



Colosseum

395 CE

The Empire is permanently split into eastern and western halves, each ruled by a separate emperor.



Goths attacking Rome

410 CE

The Goths led by Alaric sack Rome. It is the first time in 800 years the city has fallen to a foreign invader.

476 CE

Romulus Augustulus, the last Roman emperor in the West, is overthrown. The eastern Roman Empire survives until 1453 CE.

ENTERTAINMENT

Public entertainment was very important in Roman cities. Romans took part in religious festivals, or went to the theatre, public baths, and horse races. However, the most popular form of entertainment was gladiatorial contests in arenas such as the Colosseum in Rome.



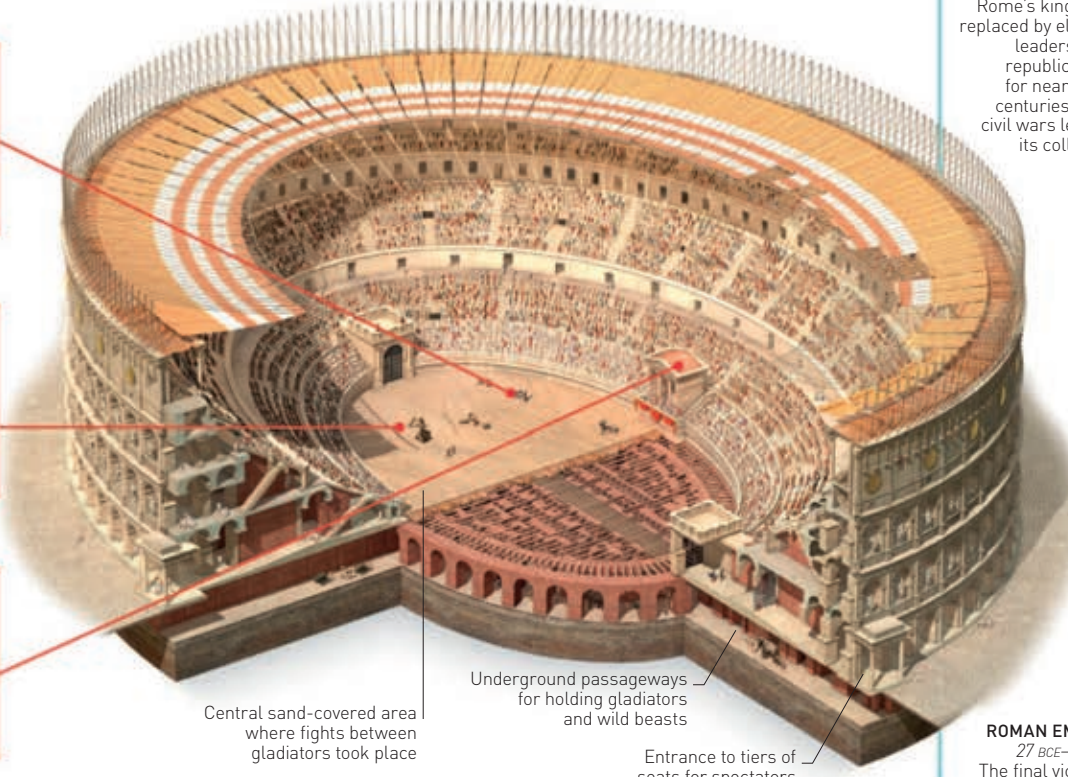
GLADIATORS



UNDERGROUND LIFT



EMPEROR'S BOX



Central sand-covered area where fights between gladiators took place

Underground passageways for holding gladiators and wild beasts

Entrance to tiers of seats for spectators

WHAT THE ROMANS DID FOR US

The Romans were brilliant engineers, builders, and scholars. Many essential things in our lives today were first introduced by the Romans.

PUBLIC BATHS

The Romans built large complexes for public bathing. These baths were the forerunners of the hammams used today in Islamic countries.

ROADS

The Romans created a network of paved roads that linked towns and cities. We still use many of these roads today.

AQUEDUCTS

Roman engineers built channels, or aqueducts, to carry water from rivers to the cities. They erected great arched structures to keep the channels straight through dips and valleys.



THE GREAT BATH, ENGLAND



ROMAN AQUEDUCT

CALENDAR

In their early calendars, the superstitious Romans avoided having months with even numbers of days because it was considered bad luck. Julius Caesar introduced a 12-month year with 365 days, which is close to the calendar we use today.

LATIN

Many European languages, such as French, Italian and Spanish, are descended from Latin, the language of the Romans.

ROMAN NUMBERS

The Romans had a numerical system that used letters to form numbers. We still use Roman numerals today on clocks and for important dates.

I 1	II 2	III 3	IV 4	V 5
VI 6	VII 7	VIII 8	IX 9	X 10
L 50	C 100	D 500	CM 900	M 1,000